

GuidelyEdu-UX-DESIGN

Brand & Style

GuidelyEdu is a **calm, institutional soft-SaaS** product for UK school and Trust staff. Visual identity is taken from the existing GuidelyEdu wireframe deck: light canvas, periwinkle/purple chrome, white cards, airy spacing, thin outline icons. The product is serious (SEND documentation, audit, statutory reasoning) but must not feel clinical, punitive, or “black box AI.”

Brand posture: **supportive infrastructure next to the MIS** — clear, explainable, low-friction. Warmth comes from soft purple primary and generous whitespace, not from consumer wellness aesthetics or emoji.

[ASSUMPTION] Implementation uses **Vue 3 + Tailwind CSS** (addendum: Vue SPA). Component primitives may be headless + Tailwind or a Vue library styled to these tokens; tokens in this file win.

Script wordmark “GuidelyEdu” matches the wireframes. Prefer an **SVG logo** in production; until then use {typography.brand} only in the top bar, never for body copy.

Colors

Token	Role
{colors.primary} / {colors.topbar}	Brand and app chrome — top bar, primary CTAs, active accents, links
{colors.primary-soft}	Soft fills (active sidebar tint, selected chips)
{colors.secondary}	Secondary CTA only (wireframe “Learn More” green). Do not use for success state alone — success uses {colors.success}
{colors.canvas}	App background behind cards
{colors.surface}	Cards, panels, modals
{colors.text} / {colors.text-muted}	Primary / secondary copy
Status soft pairs	Pills and banners: success / warning / danger / info

Do not use primary purple to mean “Gap” or “danger.” Gaps and failing Determinations use {colors.warning} or {colors.danger} with explicit labels. Primary means brand/action, not severity.

Dark mode: **out of v1**. [ASSUMPTION] Light only, matching the wireframe deck.

Typography

- **UI ramp:** Inter (or system Inter-like stack) for all product chrome and content.
- **Display / heading:** Bold for Welcome and page titles; never decorative display fonts in operational screens.
- **Metric:** Large bold numbers on KPI cards (wireframe SENCO/Educator dashboards).
- **Brand script:** Top bar logo only.
- UK English spelling in all UI strings (organisation, behaviour only if user-facing and UK-correct; prefer Glossary terms from the PRD: SENCO not SENDCO, EHCP not IEP).

Layout & Spacing

Wireframe shell for **authenticated app**:

1. Full-width {colors.topbar} (~56px) with logo left, primary nav centre/left, search + notifications + avatar right.
2. White **left sidebar** (~240px) with role-specific nav; active item uses soft fill.
3. Main column on {colors.canvas} with {spacing.page} padding; content in white {components.card} grids.

Breakpoints [ASSUMPTION]:

Breakpoint	Shell
≥1024px	Top bar + sidebar + main
768–1023px	Top bar + icon sidebar or collapsible
<768px (Hybrid Client)	Top bar + bottom nav for Teacher/Support Staff (Home, Pupils, Capture, Drafts, More); SENCO uses hamburger/sheet; single-column stacks; capture flows first

Max content width for dense tables: full main pane. School Report / Trust Dashboard may use full width. Avoid marketing two-column heroes inside the authenticated app.

Elevation & Depth

Match wireframes: **subtle card shadow** (0 1px 3px soft), not multi-layer glow. No neon, no glassmorphism. Modals: slightly stronger shadow; backdrop dim ~40% black.

Shapes

Cards {rounded.lg} (~12px). Buttons and inputs {rounded.md} / {rounded.sm}. Status pills {rounded.full}. Avatar circles {rounded.full}. Avoid sharp zero-radius tables; table chrome may sit inside a rounded card.

Components

Component	Visual contract
Top bar	Solid {colors.topbar}, white logo/nav/icons; search field light/white inset
Sidebar	White; icon + label rows; active = soft grey/purple tint
Card	White, light border optional, soft shadow, 12px radius
KPI card	Metric number + label + optional outline icon top-right
Primary button	Solid purple, white text, full-width common in card footers (wireframe pattern)
Outline quick-action	White fill, grey border, icon + label (SENCO quick actions)
Status pill	Soft bg + matching text for ready · gaps · uncovered · not-started
List row	Name + meta + chevron; divider lines
Progress bar	Track muted; fill primary or status colour by meaning
Reasoning Pathway panel	Card with clear section headers; never styled as a "score" or diagnosis badge
Disclaimer banner	Muted info soft fill; always visible on Evidence Base / Outputs

Icons: thin stroke outline (Heroicons/Lucide-like), consistent 20–24px in chrome.

Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Reuse wireframe purple top bar + sidebar + card grid	Rebuild wireframe marketing site as the staff app
Use PRD Glossary terms in chrome (SENCO, EHCP, Gap, Determination)	Use IEP, SENDCO, "client/patient", Grade 5
Keep SRE explainability visually calm and structured	Gamify Determinations or show AI "confidence %"
Stack cards on Hybrid Client; prioritise capture	Force desktop three-column dashboards on phone
Secondary green only for secondary CTAs	Paint Gaps green because "secondary is green"
Light soft shadows	Purple glow, dark mode, neon charts
SVG / licensed logo when available; script wordmark interim	Comic Sans as production brand font

Key mockups

Visual references only — this DESIGN.md and EXPERIENCE.md win on conflict.

- [mockups/teacher-capture.html](#) — Hybrid Teacher Capture Intervention (UJ-1)
- [mockups/senco-evidence-base.html](#) — SENCO Evidence Base, Gaps, Reasoning Pathway (UJ-2)
- [mockups/school-report.html](#) — School Leader School Report (UJ-3)

Remaining IA surfaces are spine-only until Architecture / build.